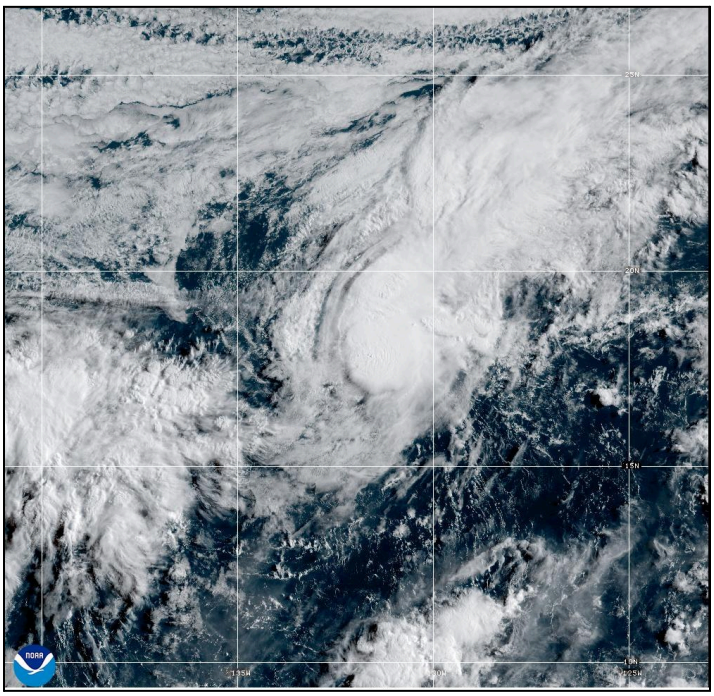
NATIONAL HURRICANE CENTER TROPICAL CYCLONE REPORT[1]

TROPICAL STORM HERNAN

(EP082026)

12–15 August 2026

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GOES-19 GEOCOLOR SATELLITE IMAGE OF TROPICAL STORM HERNAN AT 1620 UTC 13 AUGUST 2026 NEAR THE TIME OF ITS PEAK INTENSITY. IMAGE COURTESY OF NOAA/NESDIS/STAR

Hernan was a short-lived tropical storm that formed in the western portion of the eastern North Pacific basin and did not affect land.

[1] This is an abbreviated Tropical Cyclone Report since there were no coastal watches or warnings issued and no direct fatalities reported in association with Hernan.

Tropical Storm Hernan

12–15 August 2026

BEST TRACK

The "best track[2]" positions and intensities for Tropical Storm Hernan are listed in Table 1. The "best track" chart of Hernan's path is given in Fig. 1, with the wind and pressure histories along with available observations[3] shown in Figs. 2 and 3, respectively.

There were no ship observations of tropical-storm-force winds associated with Hernan.

Origin

Hernan originated from a tropical wave that interacted with a convectively active monsoon trough. The initial tropical wave could be tracked moving westward across Central America into the eastern Pacific on 4 August. Over the next several days, the low-amplitude wave moved steadily westward along the Intertropical Convergence Zone (ITCZ). On 8–10 August, shower and thunderstorm activity gradually increased along the wave axis while the ITCZ transitioned into a monsoon trough as the low-level flow shifted to southwesterly equatorward of the trough axis. The increase in shower and thunderstorm activity ultimately led to the formation of a well-defined area of low pressure by 1800 UTC 11 August. However, it took another 24 h for the low to produce enough organized convection as southwesterly vertical wind shear from another developing system farther west (eventual Hurricane Lala[4]) disrupted its structure. Ultimately, the low is estimated to have become a tropical depression at 1800 UTC 12 August, with the depression intensifying into Tropical Storm Hernan 6 h later.

Peak Intensity and Minimum Pressure

Hernan's peak intensity of 40 kt from 0600–1800 UTC 13 August is based on a combination of scatterometer wind data as well as subjective and objective satellite intensity

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[2] A digital record of the complete best track, including wind radii, can be found on line at https://ftp.nhc.noaa.gov/atcf/. Data for the current year's storms are located in the *btk* directory, while previous years' data are located in the *archive* directory.

[3] Observations include subjective satellite-based Dvorak technique intensity estimates from the Tropical Analysis and Forecast Branch (TAFB), objective Advanced Dvorak Technique (ADT) estimates and Satellite Consensus (SATCON) estimates from the Cooperative Institute for Meteorological Satellite Studies/University of Wisconsin-Madison. Data and imagery from NOAA polar-orbiting satellites including the Advanced Microwave Sounding Unit (AMSU), the NASA Global Precipitation Mission (GPM), the European Space Agency's Advanced Scatterometer (ASCAT), the Defense Meteorological Satellite Program (DMSP) satellites, and Constellations of Smallsat satellites (Tomorrow.io), among others, were also useful in constructing the best track of Hernan.

[4] When available the Hurricane Lala report will be available at:
https://www.nhc.noaa.gov/data/tcr/index.php?season=2026&basin=epac

estimates. The highest scatterometer wind was 38 kt, obtained from an ASCAT-B pass at 0502 UTC 13 August. The highest subjective intensity estimate was T3.0/45 kt from TAFB at 1800 UTC 13 August, but objective intensity estimates from ADT and SATCON at that same time were 39 kt and 38 kt, respectively. A blend of these intensity estimates also supports a maximum intensity of 40 kt on 13 August.

The estimated minimum central pressure of 1003 mb is based on the Knaff-Zehr-Courtney pressure-wind relationship.

CASUALTY AND DAMAGE STATISTICS

There were no reports of damage or casualties associated with Hernan.

FORECAST AND WARNING VERIFICATION

Table 2 provides the number of hours in advance of formation with the first NHC Tropical Weather Outlook (TWO) forecast in each likelihood category. Overall, the NHC genesis forecasts for Hernan were fair, though with less-than-optimal lead time in the 7-day probabilities and also some uncertainty of genesis in the 2-day lead time probabilities. The system that became Hernan was first mentioned in the TWO at 0600 UTC 8 August, 108 h before genesis, with a low probability (<40%) of development within 7 days. These probabilities were increased to the medium category (40–60%) at 1800 UTC 8 August, 96 h before formation. For the 2-day probabilities, a low chance was introduced 84 h before formation, and was raised into the medium category 36 h before formation. Both the 2- and 7-day probabilities were increased to the high category (>60%) via a Special TWO that was issued at 2030 UTC 11 August, 21.5 h before tropical cyclone formation. However, uncertainty remained on whether the system would develop, and the TWO probabilities were lowered back to the medium category just before it became a tropical cyclone. Figure 4 shows composites of 7-day TWO genesis areas for each category prior to the formation of Hernan. The placement of the TWO areas was good, with a 95% (19/20) hit rate overall, with only the first issued outlook area not capturing the correct genesis location.

A verification of NHC official track forecasts (OFCL) for Hernan is given in Table 3a. OFCL errors were a little higher than the mean official errors for the previous 5-yr period from 12–36 h, but then lower than the mean official errors at 48 h, though for just one forecast. A homogeneous comparison of the official track errors with selected guidance models is given in Table 3b. A number of models outperformed the official track forecast, with the HFIP Corrected Consensus Approach (HCCA) and GFS model (GFSI) besting OFCL at 12 and 24 h. A larger set of guidance outperformed OFCL during the 24-h forecast lead time. Note that guidance forecasts at 36 and 48 h lead times could not be verified due to the homogeneity requirement.

A verification of NHC official intensity forecasts (OFCL) for Hernan is given in Table 4a. OFCL errors were lower than the mean official errors for the previous 5-yr period at all forecast lead times (12–48 h). In fact, OFCL had a 0-kt error at 24 h, albeit for only 5 forecasts. A homogeneous comparison of the official intensity errors with selected guidance models is given in Table 4b. OFCL outperformed all of the intensity aids at 12 h and 24 h, though it is worth noting that overall intensity errors were low amongst the guidance as well, with both OFCL and model guidance indicating Hernan would not intensify much over its lifespan.

There were no coastal watches or warnings issued for Hernan.

Table 1. Best track for Tropical Storm Hernan, 12–15 August 2026.

Date/Time (UTC)	Latitude (°N)	Longitude (°W)	Pressure (mb)	Wind Speed (kt)	Stage
11 / 1800	16.0	129.2	1008	25	low
12 / 0000	16.7	129.7	1008	25	"
12 / 0600	17.1	130.1	1008	25	"
12 / 1200	17.4	130.4	1008	30	"
12 / 1800	17.6	130.8	1008	30	tropical depression
13 / 0000	17.8	131.2	1006	35	tropical storm
13 / 0600	17.9	131.4	1003	40	"
13 / 1200	17.9	131.8	1003	40	"
13 / 1800	17.4	131.9	1003	40	"
14 / 0000	16.9	131.9	1004	35	"
14 / 0600	16.4	131.9	1004	35	"
14 / 1200	15.8	132.0	1004	35	"
14 / 1800	15.9	132.1	1005	30	tropical depression
15 / 0000	16.2	132.4	1005	30	"
15 / 0600	16.2	133.2	1006	30	low
15 / 1200	16.1	134.4	1007	30	"
15 / 1800	15.8	135.4	1008	30	“
16 / 0000	15.9	136.3	1008	30	"
16 / 0600	16.0	137.3	1008	30	"
16 / 1200	16.4	138.5	1008	30	"
16 / 1800	16.5	139.7	1008	25	"
17 / 0000	16.5	140.7	1008	25	"
17 / 0600	16.4	141.5	1008	25	"
17 / 1200	16.7	142.3	1008	25	"
17 / 1800	17.1	143.2	1008	25	"
18 / 0000	17.5	144.1	1008	25	"

Date/Time (UTC)	Latitude (°N)	Longitude (°W)	Pressure (mb)	Wind Speed (kt)	Stage
18 / 0600	17.9	145.2	1008	25	"
18 / 1200	18.7	146.3	1008	25	"
18 / 1800	19.5	147.1	1008	25	"
19 / 0000	20.0	147.8	1008	25	"
19 / 0600	20.2	148.6	1008	25	"
19 / 1200					dissipated
13 / 0600	17.9	131.4	1003	40	Maximum winds and minimum pressure

Table 2. Number of hours in advance of formation associated with the first NHC Tropical Weather Outlook forecast in the indicated likelihood category. Note that the timings for the "Low" category do not include forecasts of a 0% chance of genesis. The asterisks for the high categories are used to note that the probabilities were ultimately lowered to medium before Hernan's genesis.

	Hours Before Genesis	
	48-Hour Outlook	**168-Hour Outlook**
Low (<40%)	84	108
Medium (40%-60%)	36	96
High (>60%)	21.5*	21.5*

Table 3a. NHC official (OFCL) and climatology-persistence skill baseline (OCD5) track forecast errors (n mi) for Tropical Storm Hernan, 12–15 August 2026. Mean errors for the previous 5-yr period are shown for comparison. Official errors that are smaller than the 5-yr means are shown in boldface type.

	Forecast Period (h)							
	12	24	36	48	60	72	96	120
OFCL	31.9	55.1	55.3	**46.1**				
OCD5	63.8	122.4	250.2	322.5				
Forecasts	7	5	3	1				
OFCL (2021-25)	21.0	31.9	41.7	50.4	60.8	73.3	99.6	124.1
OCD5 (2021-25)	35.9	72.5	113.0	154.2	196.4	239.0	325.0	405.8

Table 3b. Homogeneous comparison of selected track forecast guidance models (in n mi) for Tropical Storm Hernan, 12–15 August 2026. Errors smaller than the NHC official forecast are shown in boldface type. The number of official forecasts shown here will generally be smaller than that shown in Table 3a due to the homogeneity requirement.

Model ID	Forecast Period (h)							
	12	24	36	48	60	72	96	120
OFCL	33.7	36.0						
OCD5	60.8	**28.1**						
GFSI	**28.5**	**17.7**						
EMXI	49.9	57.4						
CMCI	55.5	64.1						
NVGI	42.8	51.2						
HFAI	34.6	37.3						
HFBI	39.7	54.6						
HWFI	44.0	**20.0**						
HMNI	34.4	57.3						
CTCI	45.5	**28.3**						
HCCA	**26.6**	**34.3**						
FSSE	34.0	**34.4**						
TVCN	36.6	36.7						
AEMI	37.9	51.6						
GFEX	36.7	37.4						
GDMI	**30.7**	45.5						
TABS	51.4	53.1						
TABM	52.9	**32.9**						
TABD	62.8	73.8						
Forecasts	5	2						

Table 4a. NHC official (OFCL) and climatology-persistence skill baseline (OCD5) intensity forecast errors (kt) for Tropical Storm Hernan, 12–15 August 2026. Mean errors for the previous 5-yr period are shown for comparison. Official errors that are smaller than the 5-yr means are shown in boldface type.

	Forecast Period (h)							
	12	24	36	48	60	72	96	120
OFCL	**2.9**	**0.0**	**1.7**	**5.0**				
OCD5	4.7	5.6	8.7	3.0				
Forecasts	7	5	3	1				
OFCL (2021-25)	5.6	8.8	10.9	12.7	13.7	14.0	15.5	16.7
OCD5 (2021-25)	7.6	12.6	16.4	19.4	21.1	21.2	21.0	21.9

Table 4b. Homogeneous comparison of selected intensity forecast guidance models (in kt) for Tropical Storm Hernan, 12–15 August 2026. Errors smaller than the NHC official forecast are shown in boldface type. The number of official forecasts shown here will generally be smaller than that shown in Table 4a due to the homogeneity requirement.

Model ID	Forecast Period (h)							
	12	24	36	48	60	72	96	120
OFCL	2.0	0.0						
OCD5	5.2	5.5						
HFAI	5.0	4.0						
HFBI	4.6	6.5						
HWFI	3.8	2.0						
HMNI	2.4	4.5						
CTCI	2.6	1.5						
DSHP	3.2	4.0						
LGEM	3.6	3.5						
HCCA	5.0	2.0						
FSSE	2.6	1.5						
IVCN	2.8	2.0						
GFSI	2.8	2.5						
EMXI	2.6	2.5						
GDMI	3.0	3.0						
Forecasts	5	2						

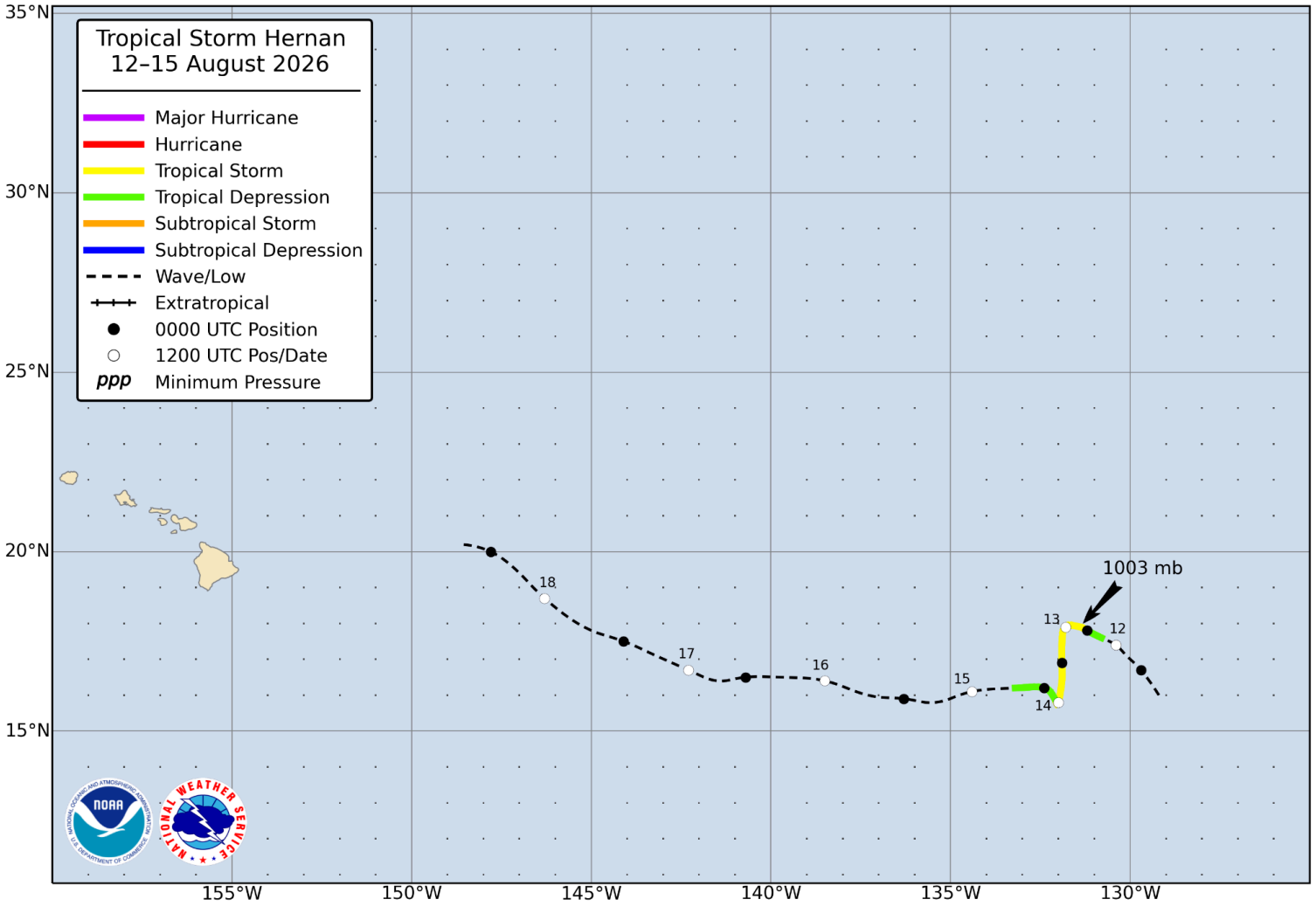


Figure 1. Best track positions for Tropical Storm Hernan, 12–15 August 2026.

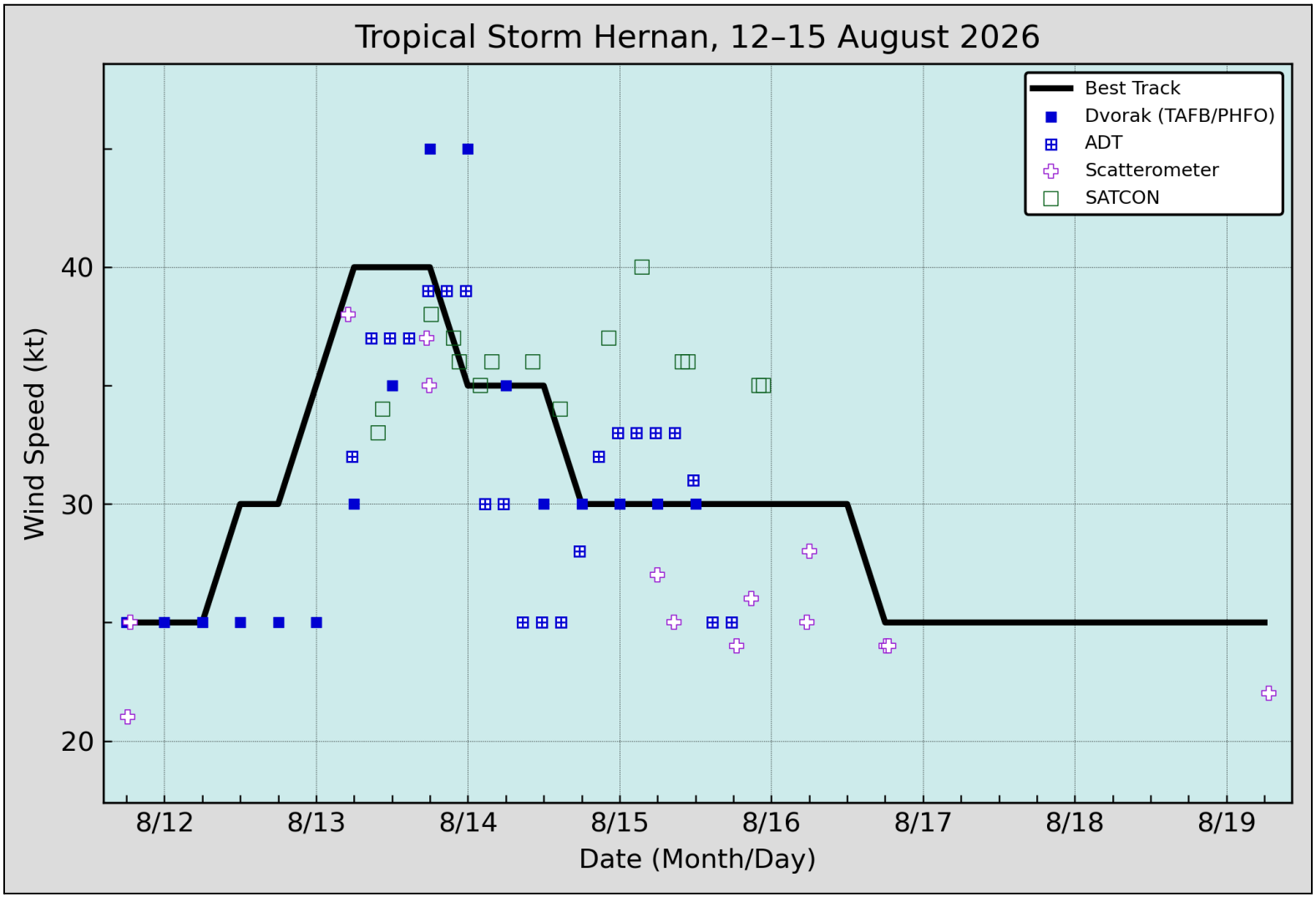


Figure 2. Selected wind observations and best track maximum sustained surface wind speed curve for Tropical Storm Hernan, 12–15 August 2026. Advanced Dvorak Technique estimates represent the Current Intensity at the nominal observation time. SATCON intensity estimates are from the Cooperative Institute for Meteorological Satellite Studies. Dashed vertical lines correspond to 0000 UTC.

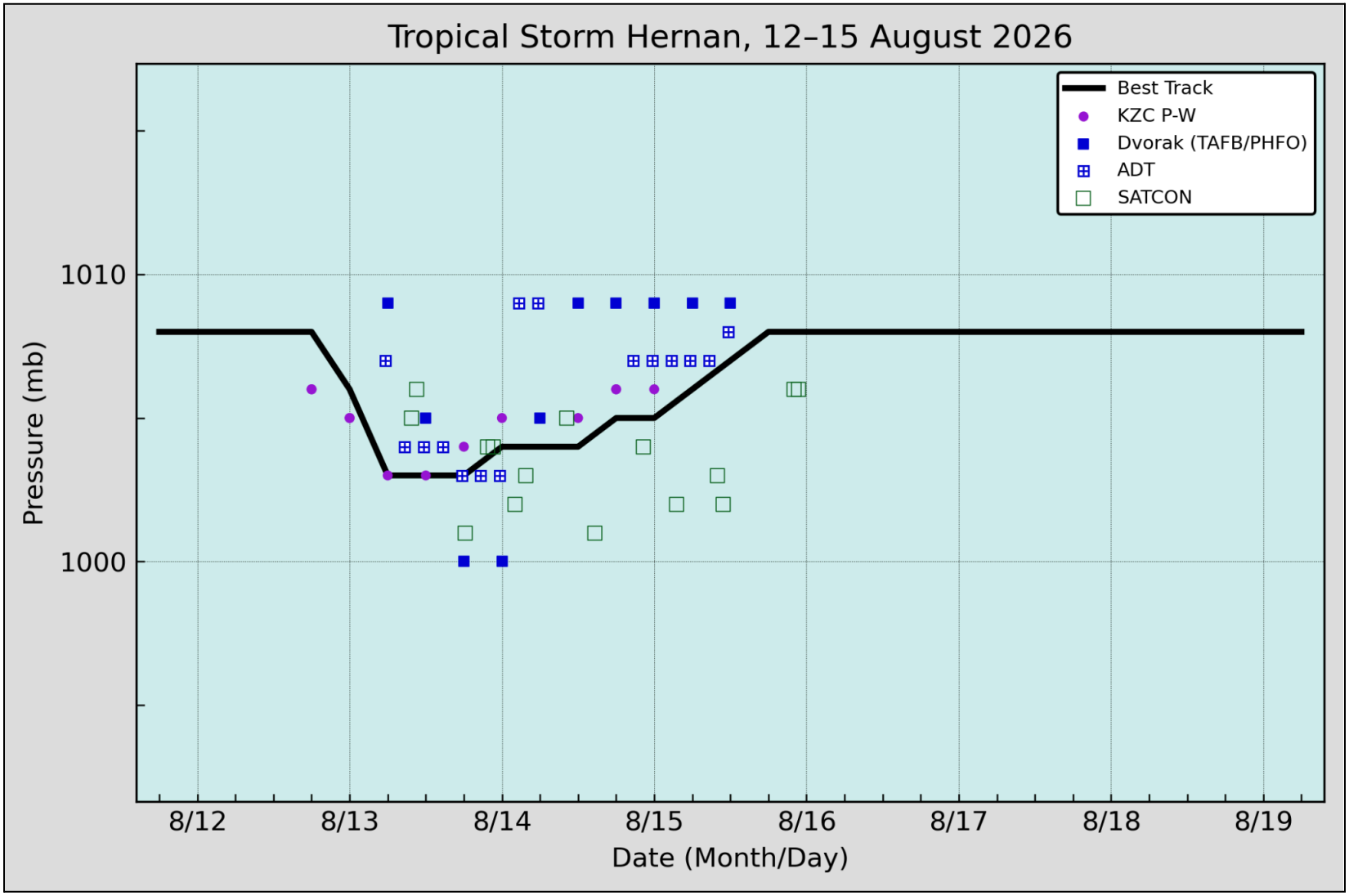


Figure 3. Selected pressure observations and best track minimum central pressure curve for Tropical Storm Hernan, 12–15 August 2026. Advanced Dvorak Technique estimates represent the Current Intensity at the nominal observation time. SATCON intensity estimates are from the Cooperative Institute for Meteorological Satellite Studies. KZC P-W refers to pressure estimates derived using the Knaff-Zehr-Courtney pressure-wind relationship. Dashed vertical lines correspond to 0000 UTC.

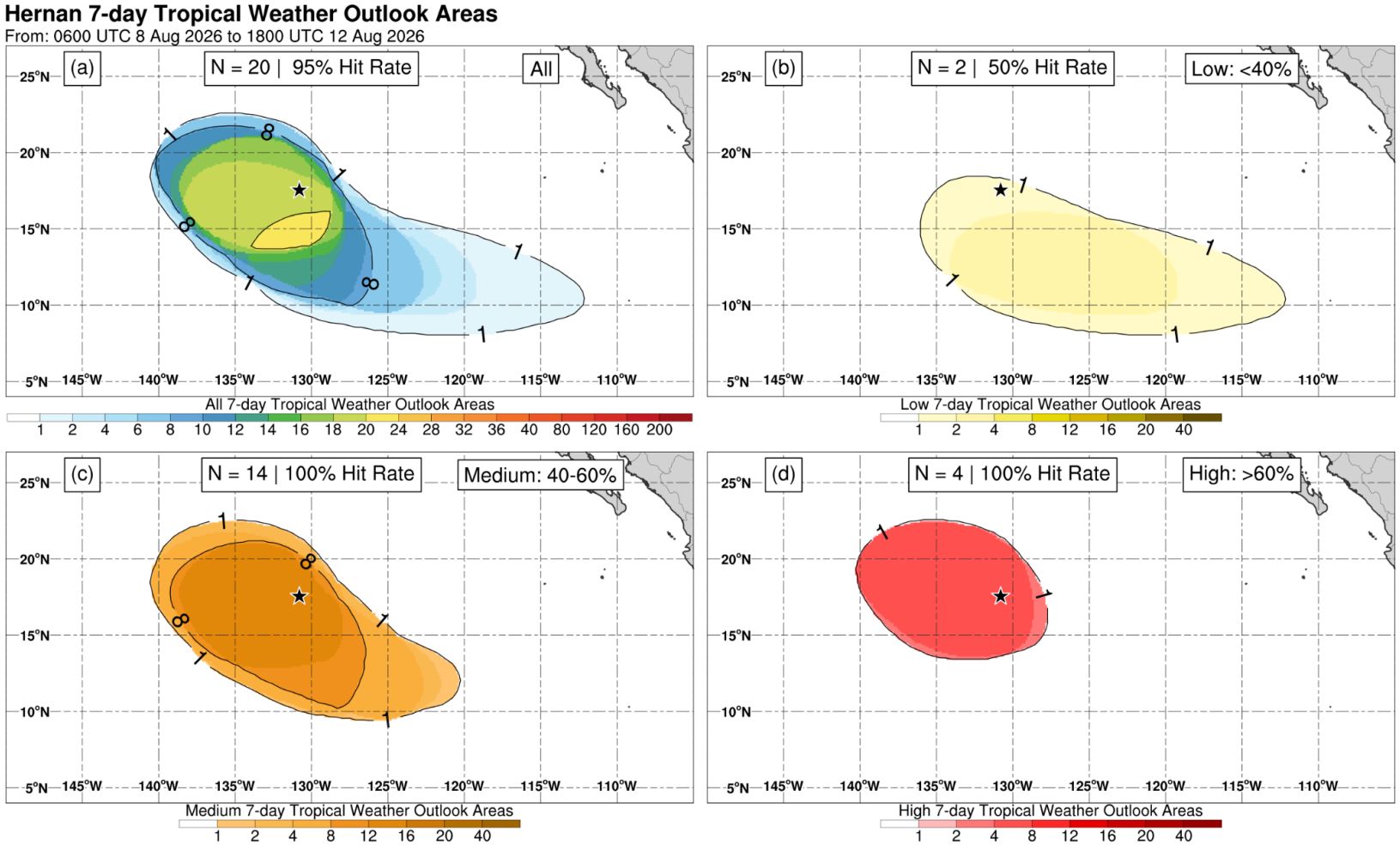


Figure 4. Composites of 7-day tropical cyclone genesis areas depicted in NHC's Tropical Weather Outlooks prior to the formation of Hernan for (a) all probabilistic genesis categories, (b) the low (<40%) category, (c) medium (40–60%) category, and (d) high (>60%) category. The location of genesis is indicated by the black star.